

Freelance Rate Card Templates + Pricing Scripts (Never Undersell Again)

RenWork Digital Products

The Five-Tier Rate Card Framework

Stop offering a single hourly rate. It invites negotiation and devalues your expertise. Instead, structure your offerings into five distinct tiers. This framework forces clients to choose the level of investment that matches their business goals, not just their budget constraints.

****Tier 1: The Starter (Entry Level)****

- * ****Goal:**** Low friction entry point for testing the waters.
- * ****Components:**** One specific, small deliverable (e.g., one blog post, one logo concept, 5 hours of admin support).
- * ****Pricing Strategy:**** 50-70% of your standard rate.
- * ****Purpose:**** To qualify leads and build trust. Do not over-sell this tier. It is a foot in the door, not a profit driver.

****Tier 2: The Essential (Core Service)****

- * ****Goal:**** The "safe" choice for most clients.
- * ****Components:**** The standard service package (e.g., 3 blog posts, 2 logo concepts + revisions, 10 hours of admin support).
- * ****Pricing Strategy:**** Your standard market rate.
- * ****Purpose:**** This should be your primary volume driver. It offers clear value without the pressure of a long-term commitment.

****Tier 3: The Growth (Value-Added)****

- * ****Goal:**** For clients who want results, not just deliverables.
- * ****Components:**** Essential tier components + strategic add-ons (e.g., SEO optimization, brand style guide, priority support, monthly strategy call).
- * ****Pricing Strategy:**** 1.5x to 2x the standard rate.

- * **Purpose:** This is where you differentiate yourself from commodity providers. You are selling outcomes, not just hours.

Tier 4: The Premium (All-In)

- * **Goal:** For established businesses needing comprehensive support.
- * **Components:** Growth tier components + dedicated time, expanded scope (e.g., 5 blog posts + distribution strategy, full brand identity system, 20 hours of admin + project management).
- * **Pricing Strategy:** 2x to 3x the standard rate.
- * **Purpose:** High margin, high impact. This tier should be scarce. Only offer it to clients who have the budget and the need.

Tier 5: The Partner (Retainer/Consulting)

- * **Goal:** Long-term revenue stability and deep integration.
- * **Components:** Monthly retainer for ongoing support, unlimited (within reasonable bounds) access, quarterly strategy reviews, first-line priority.
- * **Pricing Strategy:** Custom pricing, typically 3x+ monthly value of Tier 3.
- * **Purpose:** This is your "ideal client" tier. It reduces churn and allows you to plan your capacity.

Value-Based Pricing Formula with Worked Example

Hourly pricing is a ceiling. Value-based pricing is the sky. Use this formula to determine your true worth:

Value Price = (Client's Projected Revenue Gain or Cost Savings × Your Impact Percentage) ÷ 2

- * **Projected Gain:** How much money will your service make or save the client?
- * **Impact Percentage:** What portion of that gain can you reasonably claim? (Usually 10-30% for tangible ROI, less for intangible benefits).
- * **Divide by 2:** This ensures the client still sees a clear profit margin from hiring you, making the investment undeniable.

Worked Example:

You are a copywriter specializing in landing pages. A SaaS client is struggling with conversion. Their current landing page converts at 2%. They do \$50,000 in monthly recurring revenue (MRR) from

this page.

* **Projected Gain:** If you improve conversion to 3%, that's a 50% increase in sales. \$50,000

×

50% = \$25,000 additional monthly revenue.

* **Impact Percentage:** You claim 20% of this gain (conservative, as they also need to support

the new users). $\$25,000 \times 20\% = \$5,000$.

* **Your Price:** $\$5,000 \div 2 = \$2,500$ for the rewrite.

If you charged \$50/hour and spent 10 hours, you'd make \$500. By selling the *outcome*, you made

\$2,500 for the same work.

Market Rate Benchmarks by Niche

Use these as floor prices. If you are experienced, add 20-50%. If you are niche-specialized, add 50-100%.

* **Writing:**

* Content Marketing: \$0.15 - \$0.50/word

* Technical/Complex Copy: \$0.50 - \$1.50/word

* Brand Voice Development: \$1,500 - \$5,000 flat

* **Design:**

* Logo Design: \$500 - \$2,000 (Basic), \$2,000 - \$5,000 (Brand Identity)

* Web UI/UX: \$75 - \$200/hour

* Brand Guidelines: \$1,000 - \$3,000 flat

* **Development:**

* WordPress/Shopify: \$50 - \$100/hour

* Custom Web App: \$100 - \$250/hour

* Bug Fixing/Maintenance: \$75 - \$150/hour

* **Marketing:**

* Social Media Management: \$500 - \$2,000/month (per channel)

* SEO Audits: \$500 - \$2,500 flat

* Paid Ads Management: 10-20% of ad spend or \$1,500 - \$5,000/month

* **Virtual Assistant:**

* General Admin: \$25 - \$50/hour

* Specialized (e.g., CRM, Invoicing): \$40 - \$75/hour

- * Executive Support: \$75 - \$150/hour
- * **Consulting:**
- * Strategy Sessions: \$200 - \$500/hour
- * Workshops: \$1,000 - \$5,000 per half-day
- * Audits: \$2,000 - \$10,000 flat

Scripts: Presenting Pricing Without Apology

The "Anchor" Script:

"Thanks for the detailed brief. Based on the scope we discussed, I've put together two options. The Essential package is \$[Price A], which includes [Core Deliverables]. The Growth package is \$[Price B], which adds [Value-Add Deliverables] to ensure [Specific Outcome]. Which of these feels like the best fit for your current goals?"

- * **Why it works:** You offer two high-value options, not one. You anchor the higher price first. You never say "I charge..." You say "The package is..."

The "Confidence" Script:

"I'm confident this project will deliver [Specific Result]. My investment for this work is \$[Price]. This includes [List 2-3 Key Inclusions]. I'm available to start on [Date]. Shall I send over the agreement?"

- * **Why it works:** Direct, confident, assumes the sale. No "per hour" or "approximately."

Scripts: Handling "Your Rate Is Too High"

The "Scope Check" Script:

"I appreciate your honesty. My rates reflect the specialized expertise and results I deliver. If budget is the primary constraint, we can adjust the scope. For example, we could reduce [Element X] or extend the timeline. However, if the full scope is needed to achieve [Goal], the current investment is necessary. Would you like to explore a reduced scope, or proceed with the full plan?"

- * **Why it works:** You don't lower the price. You lower the scope. You re-state the value.

The "Comparison" Script:

"Compared to freelancers who charge \$[Lower Rate], I offer [Unique Value Prop 1] and [Unique Value

Prop 2]. My rate ensures you get [Specific Outcome] without the risk of [Common Failure Point].

Is

there a specific part of the budget that's causing the concern?"

* *Why it works:* You position yourself above the commodity market and ask for specifics, which

often dissolves the objection.

Price Raise Announcement Email Template

****Subject:**** Update to my service rates and packages

Hi [Client Name],

I hope you're having a great week.

I'm writing to let you know that as of [Date], my standard rates will be increasing by [Percentage]%. This adjustment reflects the increased demand for my services and the expanded scope of support I can offer.

For existing clients like you, I'm honored to continue our partnership. To show my appreciation, I'm offering you the option to lock in